

4 BCE

BIRTH OF JESUS

Jesus was born to Joseph, a humble carpenter, and his wife Mary, in the small town of Bethlehem in Judaea in 4 BCE. His later teachings stressed compassion and forgiveness and attracted many disciples. Claims that he was the Messiah, the long-awaited saviour of the Jewish people, brought him into conflict with the Jewish authorities in Palestine.

▷ Jesus and Mary, detail from *Comforter of the Afflicted*



9 CE **German tribes** destroy legions in the Teutoberger Wald, halting Roman expansion into Germany

24 CE

9 CE **The regent Wang Mang** overthrows the infant emperor Ruzi Ying, declaring the Xi dynasty

▽ Herod's Temple model



19 BCE

HEROD REBUILDS THE JEWISH TEMPLE

Appointed King of Judaea by the Romans, Herod maintained his kingdom's independence by balancing Jewish and Roman interests. He commissioned several projects in Jerusalem, most notably, in 19 BCE, a remodelling of the Second Temple (dating from the 6th century BCE), creating a new outer courtyard, levelling part of the Temple Mount to extend the temple platform, and building a new encircling wall, whose remains now form the Western (or Wailing) Wall.



▷ Han mirror, 1st century CE

23 CE

DEATH OF WANG MANG AND THE HAN RESTORATION

After seizing power from a weakened Han dynasty in 9 CE, Wang Mang established the Xi dynasty and embarked on a series of hugely unpopular reforms. He was killed in the ensuing rebellion in 23 CE after which Han loyalists under Emperor Guangwu took advantage of the disorder to claim power in 25 CE.